CAREER GROWTH AND SIDE HUSTLE INCOME

Building Toward $200,000 a Month

A technical consulting and education strategy for Aadil Mallick

High-ticket services. Corporate training. Guided learning. Courses and books.

Your strongest route is a specialist technical services and education business. Begin with a narrow paid offer, use your engineering and writing as proof, and expand through customer results.

The target is $200,000 in monthly gross business sales, excluding sales taxes and before refunds and operating costs. It is not a personal take-home forecast or an immediate solo side-hustle plan.

Research date: November 13, 2026. All amounts are USD. Public platform fees were checked against official pricing and help pages. Offer prices and growth assumptions are proposed experiments.

FIRST OPERATING OBJECTIVE

Establish a repeatable $5,000-$10,000 month with satisfied customers and sustainable delivery.

How to use this report

Read the business and revenue model first. Use the offer chapters to choose one primary test, the platform chapters to keep setup simple, and the 90-day plan to turn the strategy into paid validation.

Your current evidence supports technical execution and explanation. The central work ahead is commercial: finding the right buyer, proving a valuable outcome, and repeating delivery profitably.

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Source references such as [S4] point to official public sources in Chapter 16. [P1] and [P2] identify your attached resume and project context. Personal claims are distinguished from untested business hypotheses.

1. Your advantage and the gaps to close

Your best starting asset is the combination of practical engineering and technical explanation. Your attached resume reports full-stack client delivery, browser extensions, infrastructure and testing work, AI research, and substantial technical writing. The project context reinforces your stated enjoyment of teaching and freelancing. [P1, P2]

Evidence	What it supports	What it does not establish
Neural-network article reportedly exceeding 60,000 views	A relevant writing sample and potential ability to explain complex concepts	An owned email audience or existing course demand
YouTube Bookmarker and Loolite	Experience shipping browser tools and handling real product behavior	An enterprise consulting track record
BetterCare Meals client work	A starting commercial case study	Permission to publish a testimonial or access to the client's revenue data
Developer environments, tests, CI/CD, and cloud work	Credibility for bounded engineering improvement work	Authority to promise company-wide transformation
Applied mathematics and AI research	Depth for practical AI education and experiments	A reason buyers will automatically pay premium prices

The article metrics and professional results are resume claims. Verify screenshots, links, and client permission before putting them into sales collateral. Employer names can explain your experience; do not present former employers as consulting customers or endorsers.

Your strongest initial audiences: engineering agencies and small product teams with TypeScript applications; developer-tool businesses needing technical education; and developers who want guided project experience. Each gets a distinct offer page. They can share your public identity without sharing the same sales pitch.

The largest gaps are commercial: a sharply defined buyer, an urgent paid problem, a repeatable sales process, quantified independent client outcomes, and the ability to deliver without doing everything yourself. More technical topics alone will not close those gaps.

Upwork's 2026 marketplace report identifies full-stack development and scripting/automation among in-demand skills and AI integration as a fast-growing category. That is a directional reason to test engineering offers, not proof that your specific package will sell. [S1]

Positioning to test: "I help TypeScript teams make their development workflows easier to run, test, and understand, then train the team to maintain them."

Your extension work is a useful specialty and entry point. Your teaching makes handover stronger. AI belongs in the solution when it improves the work; it does not need to be the promise in every headline.

A deliberate limit on scope

Keep general web development available as an adjacent service when a qualified buyer requests it. Lead with the more specific offer. Do not advertise enterprise AI strategy, security certification, regulatory compliance, or large cloud migrations on the strength of a broad technology list. Earn higher-stakes scope through relevant delivery results and suitable collaborators.

2. The business model that fits you

Build one business with two revenue systems: services for teams and education for developers. Initially, select one primary paid offer and one light supporting activity. Develop the other lines only after passing the evidence gates below.

Business line	Job in your business	Starting priority
Workflow or extension implementation	Cash, client evidence, knowledge of expensive problems	Primary if you prefer client engineering
Commissioned tutorials and sample apps	Cash plus publicly demonstrable teaching quality	Primary alternative if writing gets faster traction
Corporate workshops	Reuse expertise across a team with one buyer	Add after a successful paid pilot
Project mentorship and cohorts	Teach directly; discover learner obstacles	Small validation track
Courses and ebooks	Reuse proven explanations and reach more buyers	Develop after paid teaching evidence
Paid community	Continuing practice and peer accountability	Optional, after recurring engagement is demonstrated

My choice for you: Spend the first 30 days testing a development-workflow sprint with small TypeScript agencies, while pitching a small number of commissioned developer tutorials. These reuse your engineering and writing proof. Continue the track producing stronger paid demand; do not maintain both at equal intensity indefinitely.

If live teaching is the work you most want, substitute a three-learner mentorship pilot for the commissioned tutorial track. The goal is a decision backed by purchases, not maximum business variety.

The long-term connection is practical: client work exposes implementation problems; permissioned or synthetic demonstrations explain them; workshops teach the reusable approach; cohorts reveal learning difficulties; courses and books package the tested material. These are different purchase decisions, so do not assume an ebook buyer will become a consulting client.

Three possible architectures

Services-led: The strongest starting recommendation. Fewer buyers are needed for meaningful revenue, but delivery and client acquisition require a team at scale.

Education-led: Potentially attractive given your writing history and interests, but it requires a reliable learner acquisition channel and teaching outcomes. Validate through paid live teaching before recording a major course.

Ebook-led: Useful for a first transaction and growing trust. Weak as the main plan for $200,000 per month because low prices require thousands of purchases. Use books as valuable products in their own right, not as a justification for unrealistic volume assumptions.

There is no SaaS requirement in this model. Do not build a learning platform, general AI product, or custom CRM to get started.

3. The mathematics of $200,000 per month

First distinguish personal labor from a business. At $200 an hour, $200,000 requires 1,000 billable hours per month. Even $500 an hour requires 400. Ordinary one-to-one tutoring cannot support this target through your own time.

Single-channel route	Volume for at least $200,000 gross	Main obstacle
$20,000 implementation	10 completed engagements a month	Sales and delivery team
$10,000 corporate workshop	20 a month	Enterprise acquisition and trainer capacity
$2,000 cohort seat	100 seats per month equivalent	Enrollment and high-quality support
$300 self-paced course	667 purchases a month	Consistent qualified traffic
$50 ebook	4,000 purchases a month	Very large distribution requirement
$100 monthly membership	2,000 active paying members	Acquisition, support, and retention

For an eight-week program approximated as two months, 100 new seats a month means approximately 200 active learners in steady state. An upfront cohort collection is not all earned in the month it is received. These simple calculations omit refunds and fees, which increase the sales required to retain a given net amount.

A mature blended scenario

The following is a capacity and demand model, not a forecast. It is deliberately diversified across services and education, but should be built sequentially.

Line	Steady-state volume and price	Monthly gross equivalent
Implementation sprints	4 completed one-month projects x $20,000	$80,000
Corporate training	4 delivered packages x $10,000	$40,000
Guided cohort	40 seats x $2,000 every two months	$40,000
Self-paced course	100 purchases x $300	$30,000
Practical ebook	200 purchases x $50	$10,000
Total	Approximately 40 active cohort learners	**$200,000**

Cohort arithmetic assumes consecutive two-month cohorts with 40 learners each. That is 20 new seats per month averaged over time, not 40 new sales every month. Implementation and workshop revenue must represent distinct paid deliverables. Do not count a workshop already included in an implementation contract as additional sales. Count course and book purchases only when separately paid, including any actual discounts.

What the target might leave after costs

Illustrative monthly statement	Amount
Gross sales from delivery	$200,000
Refunds and credits, assumed 3%	-$6,000
Net revenue after refunds	$194,000
Implementation and workshop delivery team	-$50,000
Teaching assistants, editing, and product support	-$12,000
Acquisition, affiliates, and sales support	-$20,000
Payment, platform, and course software budget	-$10,000
General operations and professional services	-$8,000
Founder compensation budget	-$12,000
Operating surplus before income taxes	**$82,000**

These are illustrative allocations, not quotes. Founder compensation is an economic cost allowance; its legal and tax classification depends on the business structure. The $82,000 is not all disposable personal income: reserves, reinvestment, and taxes remain. Affiliate and sales-support costs are already in acquisition; do not deduct them a second time.

If you mean $200,000 in monthly owner profit before personal taxes instead, a business retaining 20%, 35%, or 50% as distributable pre-tax owner profit would need approximately $1,000,000, $571,429, or $400,000 in monthly revenue respectively. Those margins are hypothetical and must include an appropriate allowance for labor and overhead. After-tax take-home requires a separate calculation.

Downside case

Suppose implementation volume falls to two projects, training to two packages, a cohort sells 20 seats every two months, courses sell 50 copies, and books sell 100. Gross sales become $100,000, not $200,000. If the example cost base stayed at $112,000 before refunds and refunds were $3,000, the business would lose $15,000 before income taxes. Some costs can flex, but not immediately. Build staffing and reserves around demand variability, not a best launch month.

4. Your consulting offer and price progression

High-ticket work begins with a valuable, bounded outcome and a buyer who can fund it. Charging more for the same vague offer is insufficient.

Initial buyer and problem

Start with TypeScript agencies or product teams of roughly 5-30 developers that maintain existing applications. Look for onboarding friction, unreliable local setup, missing validation steps, or repeated integration work. These team sizes are targeting hypotheses. Interview buyers before assuming they have budget or urgency.

Prefer a team lead, agency owner, or engineering manager who can describe a recent incident and authorize a paid diagnostic. Avoid an initial dependence on long enterprise procurement or regulated deployments.

Offer A: TypeScript Development Workflow Sprint

Pilot promise: Improve one agreed development workflow in one repository and teach the team to maintain it.

Choose one core outcome after diagnosis: reproducible onboarding; a tested pull-request validation path; or a small AI-assisted development workflow with measurable checks. Do not include all three automatically.

Component	Deliverable
Diagnosis	Current-state walkthrough, baseline measurement, prioritized recommendation
Implementation	One bounded workflow improvement with tests appropriate to the change
Validation	An agreed scenario run by someone other than its author
Handover	Runbook and recorded or live walkthrough
Support	A defined correction window for defects in the agreed scope

An onboarding acceptance test might require a developer to clone the project in a clean environment, configure documented prerequisites, start it, and run the core tests. Record baseline and final elapsed time under comparable conditions. Promise the agreed deliverable and measurement process, not a predetermined percentage improvement.

Explicit exclusions: major rewrites, production migrations, penetration testing, unbounded integrations, and continuous operational ownership. Add those only through separately priced work with appropriate expertise.

Price progression based on evidence

Stage	Proposed price	Evidence needed
Short paid diagnostic	$500-$1,500	Clear problem and useful stand-alone findings
Narrow pilot implementation	$2,500-$5,000	Scope you can deliver reliably in about 20-40 total hours
Repeatable sprint	$7,500-$12,000	Several relevant wins, repeatable method, stronger acceptance criteria
Team-delivered engagement	$15,000-$25,000	Qualified budget, material value, delegated delivery, references
Follow-up support	$1,000-$3,000 monthly test range	A real recurring service, scheduled work, and capacity limit

These are proposed tests. A small extension project may warrant less; a complex project may require far more work than this package can cover. Quote after diagnosis. Do not sell a $20,000 engagement simply because it appears in the target model.

Why a buyer could justify a larger price

Hypothetical example: eight developers each lose 1.5 avoidable hours a week, over 46 working weeks, at an internal loaded labor cost of $100 an hour. That is $55,200 of annual capacity. A $12,000 improvement could be worth discussing if you can materially recover it. Recovered hours are not automatically cash savings or extra revenue; assess adoption, durability, and whether the buyer values the capacity.

Offer B: Custom Browser Workflow Tool

Use this when the buyer has a repetitive browser task and your existing extensions establish relevance. Scope one supported website and one workflow. Diagnose whether an API integration is more reliable than an extension. Set boundaries for website changes, permissions, data access, and maintenance.

Publish a synthetic before-and-after demonstration. Ask agencies whether they need an extension specialist for an existing client. This can create subcontracting opportunities without first building a large personal following.

For larger engagements, test milestone billing such as 40% at start, 40% after demonstrated implementation, and 20% at acceptance. Treat deposits as cash received for future obligations, not immediate profit. Align the arrangement with the actual contract and buyer requirements.

5. Corporate training and education licensing

Corporate education is the strongest bridge between your teaching interest and higher-value engagements. One organization can buy learning for a team, reducing the number of individual purchasing decisions you need.

A workshop to validate

Working title: "Understand, Test, and Ship AI-Assisted TypeScript Code."

Audience: Developers already comfortable with JavaScript or TypeScript. This is not a beginner programming course or executive AI strategy session.

Outcome: Participants complete a small change, explain its behavior, test key failure cases, and review AI-generated code using an explicit checklist.

The two-hour pilot uses a prepared application and synthetic data. Teach a 20-minute model of the workflow, run a 50-minute lab, review failure cases, and finish with a practical assessment. Include prerequisites and environment setup in advance.

Test $1,000-$2,500 for an early company pilot where preparation is bounded. Once outcomes and references support it, test $5,000-$10,000 packages with a tailored lab, manager briefing, and follow-up clinic. At $10,000, the mature model assumes a meaningful training package, not an untested two-hour talk.

Alternate workshop with strong existing proof

"Build a Useful Browser Extension in TypeScript" fits your shipped projects more directly. Use it for developer communities and technical teams with a relevant use case. Keep enterprise workflow training and beginner extension learning on separate landing pages.

How to sell training

Lead with an observable work problem: developers can generate code but cannot confidently verify or maintain it; or a team has a new tool without a shared working method. Ask the manager what successful behavior should look like after training. Offer a small diagnostic conversation, then a paid pilot with an assessment.

Start with engineering leaders and agency owners. Later, pursue learning-and-development teams, developer relations organizations, and education partners. Ask buyers about procurement time, attendance requirements, and whether they can sponsor individual course seats.

Licensing without creating a second full-time job

After repeated successful delivery, package a workbook, instructor notes, lab environment, and assessment rubric. Test company licenses with defined seats, permitted internal use, update periods, and support limits. Price a license for what it includes; do not count its full annual contract value as one month's ongoing revenue. Have appropriate agreements reviewed before a significant licensing deal.

Do not sell lifetime access to unlimited personal updates. Prefer a stated version or support period and a clear renewal offer. Teaching assistants or trained facilitators can eventually lead labs while you improve the material and manage key accounts.

6. Tutoring and premium project mentorship

Tutoring is a strong first-revenue and customer-learning avenue. It becomes a large business through groups, sponsored seats, or other instructors, rather than unlimited personal hours.

Three tutoring offers to consider

Offer	Learner	Starting test
Ship and understand an extension	Learner with JavaScript basics	Four sessions, $400-$800, bounded review
Mathematical ML through code	Learner with Python and prerequisite mathematics	Diagnostic lesson, then a scoped package
Debug your TypeScript project	Developer with a concrete learning goal	Paid session or short package with clear objectives

Your mathematical background supports ML tutoring; your extensions provide a particularly tangible project. Use a prerequisite questionnaire so an advanced project does not become an emergency basics course. Teach the learner to do and explain the work. Do not complete graded assignments for them.

Try a direct hourly range such as $75-$125 only as a pricing experiment. At $100 for 40 billable hours a month, gross sales are $4,000 before preparation, acquisition, fees, and taxes. That is useful income, but it explains why personal tutoring is not the final $200,000 architecture.

Where to find learners

Use a focused page on your website, educational content, referrals, alumni or student communities where relevant, and optionally Wyzant. Wyzant's standard tutor fee is 25%; it also lists a distinct referral arrangement. A $100 posted hourly rate ordinarily leaves $75 before other costs. Review and respect its payment policies for platform-sourced students. [S11]

Do not assume that people reading AI articles want tutoring or that alumni networks will automatically provide buyers. Test a specific invitation to a specific project outcome.

From tutoring to a cohort

First teach three to five paying learners. Record recurring misconceptions and preparation needs. Then pilot a six-week group with six to ten learners, one core project, weekly teaching, and review limits. A $300-$750 beta seat is a starting hypothesis. At eight learners x $500, gross cohort sales are $4,000 over the six-week program, not $4,000 in earned revenue every month.

Only consider $1,000-$2,000 seats after learners reliably finish and can explain their work, the experience provides meaningful feedback, and acquisition supports the price. Employer reimbursement can be a separate purchasing route, but requires a useful syllabus, invoice, and clear outcome.

At the mature model's 40 active learners, divide reviews into small groups and use teaching assistants. Two hours of individual weekly attention per learner would require 80 hours a week before teaching; that is not viable for you alone. Price and promise group support honestly.

7. Courses and ebooks worth selling

Start with a specific transformation, not the largest possible body of knowledge. Your notes and previous curriculum work are raw material. A sellable product still needs verified examples, intentional sequencing, exercises, editing, and a reason someone prefers it over free material.

Product sequence tailored to you

Product	Specific result	Proposed initial price
TypeScript Browser Extension Field Guide	Build, debug, and package one useful extension	$29-$49
Companion repository and exercises bundle	Apply the guide with tested examples	$79-$129 bundle
Understand and Ship an Extension course	Complete a project with demonstrations and checkpoints	$149-$299 after a live pilot
Cohort version	Complete the project with scheduled feedback	Validate low first; later test $1,000-$2,000
Neural Networks You Can Trace	Follow forward and backward computation in small examples	Second product after demand is observed

The extension guide is my recommended first product because your existing software provides practical specificity. Your neural-network article makes a mathematics-led product a credible alternative if your actual readers show stronger paid interest there. Compare signups and purchases, not personal

attachment to the topic.

First guide specification

Use six chapters: architecture and permissions; popup and content-script communication; storage and data handling; working with changing pages; testing and debugging; packaging and maintenance. Include one complete project, three exercises, worked solutions, a troubleshooting index, and an explicit tested-version date.

Explain the difficult implementation choices. Do not sell an unedited repository dump or a huge generated PDF. Any AI-assisted text and code must be checked by you for correctness, licensing, and instructional quality.

Validate before recording

Publish one complete sample lesson and a short demonstration. Invite a waitlist with explicit email consent. Offer a live pilot only when you can state its contents, delivery date, support, and refund conditions. Ten paid guide or workshop buyers are a useful initial signal; they do not validate hundreds of monthly course sales.

Record the course after live learners reveal where explanations fail. A short course that gets buyers to a finished result is commercially stronger than an unfinished comprehensive academy.

Ebook economics

A $50 ebook needs 4,000 monthly purchases to gross $200,000. At a hypothetical 2% purchase rate, that means 200,000 qualified product-page visits every month. General social impressions are not product-page visits, and repeat exposure does not equal new buyers.

The mature blended model asks books for $10,000, or 200 purchases a month. Even that requires 10,000 qualified visits at the same assumed 2% rate. Books can support trust and profit, but they are not automatically an easy traffic engine.

Bundles and company purchases

Offer a book plus course bundle only if both are useful and the savings are transparent. Company packages can include several seats and one bounded Q&A. Exclude redistribution and unlimited consulting. Count actual bundle revenue once; do not count included books or seats again at their list prices.

8. Customer acquisition and content strategy

Use separate acquisition plans for business buyers and learners. They share expertise, but they differ in urgency, budgets, and buying process.

Business acquisition

Start with warm introductions, agency partnerships, and highly relevant direct approaches. Research companies with visible TypeScript projects, hiring or onboarding activity, developer documentation, or an expressed workflow problem. Look for evidence of a need rather than assuming every company using your stack is a prospect.

In an initial working week, identify ten qualified accounts, draft five genuinely tailored approaches, conduct available conversations, and publish one relevant demonstration. The counts are an activity budget, not a promised response rate. Keep outreach compliant with the applicable channel and do not use mass unsolicited automation.

Record the buyer's role, trigger, current workaround, consequence, budget process, next step, and timing. A technical employee who likes your demo is not necessarily a budget owner or qualified opportunity.

What the mature sales model requires

Four implementations plus four separately sold training packages means eight B2B purchases per month. At an assumed 25% close rate from held qualified calls, that requires 32 such calls. At an assumed 80% show rate, schedule 40 calls. If 5% of carefully targeted contacts book, an outbound-only version requires 800 contacts per month. These rates are arbitrary scenario inputs, not benchmarks.

If the close rate is 10%, the requirement rises to 80 held calls, 100 scheduled calls, and 2,000 contacts at the same other assumptions. That is why your mature plan needs referrals, partners, repeat buyers, and support with sales rather than unlimited personal cold outreach. An agency partner can supply opportunities, but introduces margin and concentration costs.

Expect a delay between initial contact and purchase, especially for corporate work. A month of outreach does not guarantee the same month's closes. Track pipeline by expected delivery date and confidence.

Learner acquisition

Use LinkedIn for short demonstrations and practical explanations, YouTube or searchable articles for deeper instruction, and an opt-in email list for continuing education and offers. Medium can demonstrate teaching quality; it does not replace permission to contact readers.

An initial weekly cadence could be one substantive tutorial or demo, two short adaptations, and one useful email. Keep it within a realistic time budget. A tutorial can supply a demonstration, a lesson excerpt, and an invitation without requiring unrelated daily content.

Three recurring themes fit you: how a browser feature works; how to debug a real failure; and how to understand and test AI-assisted code. Keep a separate buyer-oriented series on team workflow outcomes. Each piece should lead to one appropriate next step.

What the mature learner model requires

For 20 new cohort seats a month, a hypothetical 5% purchase rate from qualified, engaged launch leads requires 400 such leads per month. At 2%, it requires 1,000. These are people reached by a relevant offer, not all email subscribers or webinar registrations.

For 100 course purchases at a hypothetical 2% product-page conversion rate, you need 5,000 qualified visits a month. For 200 book purchases at 2%, you need 10,000. If these audiences overlap, model the actual sequence and paid orders. Do not add the same visitor to several funnels without accounting for overlap.

Partner workshops, educator collaborations, and relevant newsletters can supplement your audience. Test paid advertising only after tracking conversion, refunds, and customer acquisition cost. Likes and views alone do not establish unit economics.

9. Website and platform decisions

Your own website should be the permanent front door. A hosted platform can handle checkout, course delivery, or community. You do not need to choose between having a website and using Gumroad or Skool.

Recommended website structure

Route	Purpose	Primary action
/consulting	One team workflow offer with fit criteria	Apply for a short fit call
/chrome-extension	Extension service and relevant examples	Describe a workflow
/training	Corporate workshop outcomes and prerequisites	Request a workshop discussion
/learn	Cohort, mentorship, and course choices	Choose a learning path
/books	Sample lesson and guide details	Buy the guide
/writing	Tutorial portfolio and commissioned packages	Request a tutorial proposal
/case-studies	Permissioned client evidence and synthetic demos	Explore the relevant offer

Keep one coherent brand. Launch only the pages needed for active offers. Reuse the existing freelancer site work if suitable; do not delay sales for a redesign. Use hosted checkout and a simple contact form before custom accounts or dashboards.

Platform comparison

Prices are public standard listings checked November 13, 2026, excluding promotions and applicable taxes. Monthly and annual billing are distinguished. Processing, optional services, eligibility, and regional rates can change the total.

Avenue	Current price or fee signal	Best fit and recommendation
Own site plus Stripe	Standard US domestic cards 2.9% + $0.30; other product fees can apply	Consulting and direct payments; you manage the surrounding operations. [S2]
Gumroad	No monthly fee; direct sales generally 10% + $0.50 plus card processing; Discover 30% including processing	Fast ebook validation. Its help page lists a lower marginal rate after $20,000 monthly paid sales. [S3, S4]
Lemon Squeezy	Base 5% + $0.50 with additional fees in some cases; merchant of record	Approved digital downloads; do not use for consulting or tutoring services. [S5-S7]
Skool	Hobby $9/month; Pro $99/month; fees vary by plan and payment amount	Group practice and community once there is actual engagement. [S8, S9]
Maven	10% platform fee plus processing	A live professional cohort or workshop; marketplace exposure is not guaranteed demand. [S10]
Wyzant	Standard tutor platform fee 25%	Optional tutoring discovery and initial teaching experience. [S11]
Teachable	Starter $39/month plus 7.5%; Builder $89/month with 0% platform transaction fee using its payments; processing extra	Structured self-paced course delivery. [S12, S13]
Podia	Annual equivalents: Mover $42/month plus 5%; Shaker $84/month with no Podia transaction fee; processing extra	Simpler combined course/download/community setup; verify email limits and add-ons. [S14]
Kajabi	Monthly Basic $179, Growth $249, Pro $499; processing and some outside-processor fees apply	Consider when integrated marketing replaces enough separate work or tools. [S15]

Lemon Squeezy explicitly prohibits services including consulting and web development. Use it only for approved digital goods; confirm the proposed course format and any mixed bundle before onboarding. Its merchant-of-record role concerns transaction taxes, not your business income taxes. [S5-S7]

My platform choice for you

Now: Your website for positioning and applications; Stripe or an appropriate business invoicing process for services; Gumroad for the first guide if fastest to launch; existing video-call and scheduling tools for mentorship. Use one email system and a simple lead tracker. Check service eligibility with the chosen processor before accepting payments.

After a successful live pilot: Choose Maven if its cohort tools and relevant marketplace reach justify the percentage, or Skool if a continuing learning group is central. For a mostly self-paced product, evaluate Teachable or Podia instead. Do not subscribe to all of them.

At substantial volume: Recalculate fees, support work, tax handling, migration cost, and conversion. Negotiate volume pricing where available. A small percentage difference matters, but a cheaper checkout that reduces trust or adds operational work can be worse.

Skool specifically

Do not launch a generic community about coding and making money. A credible initial group would be an alumni practice lab for your extension course, with scheduled build reviews, monthly challenges, and peer feedback. Test whether graduates want ongoing help before charging monthly.

At $100 per month, 2,000 active members gross $200,000. At an assumed 5% monthly member churn, you need 100 new paying members every month just to replace departures. At 10%, you need 200. No amount of course uploads removes that retention work.

Use Skool because its group experience supports the offer, not because it is expected to supply buyers automatically. It is optional in the recommended revenue model.

10. Fees and unit economics

Example proceeds from a $50 digital purchase

The following calculations assume a US domestic one-time card payment, no tax added to the fee base, no affiliate, no refund, and no negotiated rate. They show proceeds after stated transaction fees only, not profit.

Route	Calculation	Proceeds
Gumroad direct, initial marginal tier	$50 - 10% - $0.50 - 2.9% - $0.30	$42.75
Gumroad direct, lower marginal tier	$50 - 5% - $0.50 - 2.9% - $0.30	$45.25
Gumroad Discover	$50 - 30%	$35.00

Route	Calculation	Proceeds
Lemon Squeezy, base case	$50 - 5% - $0.50	$47.00
Stripe, standard domestic card	$50 - 2.9% - $0.30	$48.25

Gumroad's fee help page lists the 5% + $0.50 platform tier for new direct sales after monthly paid sales reach $20,000; it resets monthly and does not change card processing or Discover pricing. Do not apply the lower rate retroactively to all sales. The headline pricing page omits some details that the fee article supplies. [S3, S4]

Lemon Squeezy lists extra charges including international payments, PayPal, subscriptions, and certain marketing functions. Fees can be assessed on tax-inclusive order value. Stripe's transaction example excludes hosting, delivery software, tax tools, and other products such as invoicing or billing where charged. These routes provide different services, so fee arithmetic alone is not a full comparison. [S2, S5, S6]

Skool plan decision

Its payment FAQ lists Hobby at 10% + $0.30. Pro lists 2.9% + $0.30 for transactions up to $899, and 3.9% + $0.30 above $900. The published wording leaves the exact $900 boundary unclear; confirm it if pricing there. Do not add another standard Stripe fee to the listed Skool processing rate. [S8, S9]

For payments entirely in the lower Pro band, the extra monthly plan cost is $90 and the percentage saving is 7.1 points: $90 / 0.071 = approximately $1,268 in monthly paid volume. For payments entirely in the higher band, $90 / 0.061 = approximately $1,475. Identical fixed transaction charges cancel in this simplified comparison. Features and billing terms may also matter.

Teachable's 0% platform transaction fee also does not mean zero total fees. Its current payments guide lists base processing plus optional bundle charges: the Standard bundle can add 0.5% where tax is assessed and 0.7% for recurring payments; Global adds 2.8% instead of those particular charges. Compare the account's actual configuration, especially for subscriptions and international buyers. [S13]

For 20 seats at $2,000, gross cohort cash collections are $40,000. Skool Pro's 3.9% + $0.30 produces $1,566 in transaction fees, plus the monthly plan. Refunds and other costs remain. This is an illustration for a cohort sale, not the mature model's full 40-seat cohort.

Acquisition cost limits

For a hypothetical $300 course, assume $18 in platform/payment costs, $15 expected refunds, and $30 variable support. Contribution before acquisition is $237. If you want to keep $150 toward overhead and profit, maximum acquisition spend is $87 per customer. At a 2% click-to-purchase rate, the corresponding maximum cost per click is $1.74. These inputs must come from your own results before scaling advertising.

For a $20,000 consulting project with $8,000 delivery cost, $1,000 fees and rework allowance, and a desired $7,000 contribution, acquisition spend cannot exceed $4,000. Include your sales time and partner

commission. A high contract price can conceal poor economics if every deal consumes months of unpaid work.

Cash versus revenue

Track booked contracts, cash collected, delivery obligations, net earned revenue, and operating profit separately. Keep tax collections outside sales. Upfront annual memberships, deposits, and multi-month cohorts create future obligations. Use suitable accounting support as volume grows; platform sales-tax handling does not settle all of your business tax responsibilities.

11. Team, capacity, and delivery

At the mature target, you are directing a small specialist firm and teaching business. You cannot simultaneously perform every implementation, review every learner's code, edit every video, and personally source every sale.

Capacity test for the blended model

Assume each implementation needs 40 contractor engineering hours and three founder oversight hours: four projects require 160 engineering hours and 12 founder hours. If the actual scope needs 80 engineering hours, staffing and margins change immediately.

Assume each corporate package uses four founder hours for preparation and delivery, plus 12 staff hours for customization and operations: four packages use 16 founder and 48 staff hours. This assumes a reusable workshop. A highly bespoke workshop needs a different price or lower volume.

For 40 active cohort learners, reserve approximately 12 founder hours a month and 80 teaching-assistant hours for sessions, preparation, feedback, and coordination. That level requires group instruction and limited review. Validate learner outcomes before accepting this scale.

Founder monthly allocation	Hours
Implementation oversight	12
Corporate training	16
Cohort instruction and preparation	12
Sales, partner calls, and proposals	36
Content direction and writing	16
Operations and team leadership	20

Founder monthly allocation	Hours
Buffer, learning, and unexpected issues	24
Total	**136**

This is a design constraint, not a forecast. The model also needs substantial engineering, instructional, editing, operations, and acquisition work from others. The earlier budget allocates $62,000 to delivery and education support; this covers an indicative pool, not an approved staffing plan or a verified market quote. Log actual hours and compare them to the model every month.

Hiring order

After repeatable paid work, begin with bounded subcontracting for implementation or a teaching assistant for a proven cohort, whichever relieves the actual bottleneck. Next add administrative/customer support and editing. Add sales support after you can personally explain why deals close and reject poor-fit prospects.

Keep architecture, quality standards, learning design, and important relationships under your control initially. Document acceptance tests and handovers before delegating. Contractors need clear responsibility, confidentiality, ownership, access limits, and review arrangements appropriate to the engagement.

Quality and resilience

Maintain a delivery checklist, a correction process, a capacity calendar, and a record of promised support. Train a second facilitator before promising more workshops than you can personally cover. Avoid concentration where one partner or client determines most of the business. Maintain a cash buffer aligned with payroll, refunds, and delayed collections.

A side-hustle schedule can validate offers. Sustained $200,000 monthly sales would require a different operating commitment or substantial management support. There is no evidence-based arrival date for you yet; use the milestones rather than a promised 12-month trajectory.

12. Milestones and the first 90 days

Advance through evidence gates

Stage	What to establish	Next commitment
First $1,000-$5,000 collected	A real buyer pays and you deliver the promised result	Refine one offer and obtain permissioned evidence
Repeatable $5,000-$10,000 months	Multiple satisfied buyers, tracked hours, repeat demand	Raise price where value and delivery support it
$20,000-$30,000 months	Predictable qualified pipeline and documented process	Bounded delivery help or teaching assistance
$50,000 months	Several months of healthy delivery economics and demand	Dedicated operations and repeatable training
$100,000 months	Multiple functioning channels and reliable delegation	Improve throughput and reduce concentration
$200,000 months	Team capacity, educational distribution, and quality at scale	Defend retention, profit, and reserves

These are management checkpoints, not promised milestones or a recommendation to hire on revenue alone. Require cash, backlog quality, margins, and delivery health. A single launch spike does not validate the next stage. Review a three-month average and future obligations.

Days 1-14: select the buyer and sell a small result

Choose the development-workflow sprint as the primary test unless the first conversations strongly favor commissioned tutorials. Prepare one offer page, a short diagnostic checklist, and two proof pieces from work you can share. Verify article metrics before using them. Ask BetterCare Meals whether it would permit a case study; do not fabricate a quote or infer customer outcomes from its website.

List 20 suitable accounts or warm introductions. Draft relevant approaches and seek five conversations. Your output is a scoped paid opportunity, not a polished brand system. Spend at most one focused day adapting the website needed for the active offer.

Days 15-30: deliver a pilot

Seek one paid diagnostic or narrow implementation and, if capacity permits, one commissioned tutorial or teaching pilot. Document the initial problem, agreed success criteria, total time, and result. Ask for candid feedback and permission to publish a factual case study.

An illustrative starting month could be one $1,000 diagnostic plus one $3,000 implementation. If the diagnostic is credited toward that implementation, total sales are $3,000, not $4,000. Keep the scope and accounting consistent.

Days 31-60: choose the winning track

Review which audience pays, which work you enjoy, and which results are repeatable. Improve the scope and proposal. Seek a second and third engagement. Test a paid workshop with an existing buyer if there is a relevant learning need.

If ten qualified conversations produce no paid work, do not record a course as an escape. Review urgency, buyer authority, trust, scope, and price. If you cannot reach qualified conversations, fix targeting and the approach first.

Days 61-90: package the repeated lesson

Turn one repeated problem into a sample lesson and a live workshop or guide. Ask previous learners or relevant readers whether they want that specific result. Deliver a small paid pilot before a large recording effort. Document the delivery process and delegate only a bounded task you can review.

The planning objective is to find a repeatable $5,000-$10,000 month, not to guarantee it by day 90. If evidence is weaker, narrow the offer and extend validation rather than increasing fixed costs.

Default weekly schedule

Until availability is confirmed, use ten hours a week only as a provisional side-hustle planning budget: three for acquisition, four for paid delivery or its most necessary proof asset, one for content, one for improving the offer, and one for review and administration. If paid delivery exceeds this capacity, reduce concurrent offers or arrange more time explicitly.

13. Sales assets and conversation guides

The examples below are drafts to adapt. They do not imply that research, outreach, or permission has already occurred.

Short consulting pitch

"I help small TypeScript teams improve one development workflow, such as getting a project running reliably or validating changes before release. My background includes full-stack client work, browser tools, and developer-environment improvements. If onboarding or review friction is costing your team time, I can start with a small paid diagnostic and propose a bounded implementation."

Use a specific observation about the prospect only after verifying it. Do not claim their setup is broken based on a public stack list.

Technical tutorial pitch

"I build working technical examples and explain them step by step. I have published on neural networks and agent skills, and I build TypeScript and browser tools. I would like to propose a tutorial showing your users how to complete [specific supported integration], with a reproducible repository and short demo. Would that fill a gap in your current onboarding material?"

Replace the bracketed concept with a researched proposal. Include a relevant sample, a defined revision limit, delivery timing, and usage rights in the eventual quote.

Discovery questions

Ask what happened recently, who experiences the problem, what the current workaround costs, why it matters now, what has already been attempted, and who approves spend. Ask what successful behavior would look like after implementation or training. For technical work, inspect access and dependencies before committing to scope.

End with a concrete next step: a diagnostic proposal, a sample workshop agenda, or an honest no-fit conclusion. A pleasant call without a next decision is not a reliable pipeline stage.

One page proposal structure

State the observed problem; name the agreed outcome; list included deliverables and exclusions; give acceptance criteria and client dependencies; state the schedule, payment milestones, correction window, and change process. Include separate prices for optional follow-up rather than implying unlimited access.

Proof asset requirements

A case study should state your actual role, starting situation, intervention, comparable measurement, and limitations. Distinguish client results from a synthetic demo. A testimonial must be an authentic, permissioned statement. For an educational offer, show an explanation and exercise rather than relying only on credentials or article views.

14. Operating scorecard and decisions

Review the business weekly for activity and monthly for economics. Compare each offer separately; strong course margins should not conceal unprofitable consulting.

Metric	Why it matters	Action if weak
Qualified conversations by channel	Shows whether acquisition reaches buyers	Change targeting or relevance
Proposals and paid wins	Reveals offer and trust problems	Review objections and buyer authority
Sales-cycle length	Connects pipeline to future cash	Plan reserves and follow-up timing
Contribution per engagement	Tests price against variable costs	Narrow scope, improve process, or reprice
Total founder hours per sale	Exposes unpaid sales and support	Standardize and delegate carefully
Learner completion and demonstrated ability	Tests teaching value	Improve prerequisites and exercises
Refunds, rework, and support demand	Signals promise or delivery mismatch	Fix causes before acquiring more buyers
Repeat purchases and referrals	Indicates durable usefulness	Follow up on outcomes
Course purchase conversion and acquisition cost	Tests scalable distribution	Improve fit before increasing ad spend
Cash and future delivery obligations	Prevents spending deposits as profit	Reduce commitments or preserve reserves

Set decision thresholds using your own early results. For a cohort, review actual work samples and completion, not only satisfaction scores. For a consulting sprint, test the promised workflow, not the number of files produced.

Actions to avoid

Do not launch several unrelated courses at once, promise earnings or jobs, buy a large ad campaign before measuring conversion, build a custom platform before demand, or hire against hoped-for revenue. Do not confuse a large generated curriculum with a finished product. Do not promise unsupported enterprise expertise to justify a high fee.

Do not make follower growth the operating goal. A few suitable business relationships can generate more revenue than broad but unqualified attention. Conversely, education at volume does require real distribution; strong code alone does not create it.

15. How ChatGPT should support execution

Use the project context and your actual progress to select the next revenue-relevant task. Ask for your weekly capacity, first income target, current audience, and preferred work style when they change the decision. Keep moving on tasks that do not depend on those answers.

The most valuable immediate outputs are a sharply scoped offer page, a proof-asset inventory, a researched prospect list, tailored outreach drafts, a proposal, a workshop exercise, and a simple sales-and-delivery tracker. ChatGPT can draft, research, compare, and help implement these. You verify personal claims and authorize external actions.

For each weekly review, record: conversations, paid commitments, money collected, work delivered, total hours, costs, repeated objections, customer feedback, and the next experiment. Update assumptions rather than generating a fresh strategy every week.

Your first action: Choose whether you want the first ten paying customers to be businesses buying implementation or learners buying teaching. My recommendation is businesses first, with your strongest teaching sample used to support trust. Prepare one development-workflow sprint page and one factual case study this week, then seek the first paid diagnostic. If the first conversations favor technical tutorials, follow that evidence rather than forcing the original offer.

The route to the large target is repeated proof: a buyer pays, you deliver, the buyer benefits, acquisition repeats, and delivery becomes less dependent on your personal hours. Courses, ebooks, and community should grow from that evidence.

16. Sources and assumptions

Personal sources

[P1] Aadil_s_Resume_SWE_variant.pdf, attached project source, reviewed November 13, 2026. Professional accomplishments, education, project details, publication history, and article metrics are attributed to the resume rather than independently audited.

[P2] Aadil-Mallick-Project-Context.md, attached project source, reviewed November 13, 2026. Used for stated preferences, previous positioning hypotheses, and continuity. Its proposed offers are not evidence of existing sales.

Official public sources

[S1] Upwork, In-Demand Skills 2026. Marketplace-specific hiring evidence, not an earnings forecast. https://www.upwork.com/press/releases/upworks-in-demand-skills-2026-demand-for-top-ai-skills-more-than-doubles-as-ai-is-embedded-into-everyday-work

[S2] Stripe pricing. Standard US domestic card and other payment pricing; separate products and regional fees can apply. https://stripe.com/pricing?locale=en-US

[S3] Gumroad pricing. Direct and Discover headline rates and merchant-of-record role. https://gumroad.com/pricing

[S4] Gumroad fees. Processing exclusions, marginal volume discount, and fee details. This report uses the detailed help page where the headline page is incomplete. https://gumroad.com/help/article/66-gumroads-fees

[S5] Lemon Squeezy pricing. Base price and merchant-of-record model. https://www.lemonsqueezy.com/pricing

[S6] Lemon Squeezy fees. Additional transaction, payout, and marketing charges. https://docs.lemonsqueezy.com/help/getting-started/fees

[S7] Lemon Squeezy prohibited products. Digital-goods scope and prohibition on services. https://docs.lemonsqueezy.com/help/getting-started/prohibited-products

[S8] Skool pricing. Monthly Hobby and Pro subscription prices. https://www.skool.com/pricing

[S9] Skool Payments FAQs. Transaction bands, refund treatment, and payment model. https://help.skool.com/article/86-subscriptions-faq

[S10] Maven Expert Policy Guidebook, dated October 2, 2026. Fees, processing, and refund obligations. https://help.maven.com/en/articles/12240853-maven-expert-policy-guidebook

[S11] Wyzant tutor fee structure and payment policies. https://support.wyzant.com/tutors/tutor-payments/what-is-the-fee-structure-for-tutors-listed-on-wyzant/ and https://support.wyzant.com/tutors/tutor-payments/tutor-payment-policies/

[S12] Teachable pricing. Standard monthly and annual plans. https://www.teachable.com/pricing

[S13] Teachable transaction fees and bundles. https://support.teachable.com/en/articles/15661316-understand-your-transaction-fees-and-bundles

[S14] Podia pricing. Annual equivalents, platform fees, processing, and included email limits. https://www.podia.com/pricing

[S15] Kajabi pricing. Standard monthly plans, native processing, and outside-processor fees. https://www.kajabi.com/pricing

Public pricing was researched November 13, 2026. Confirm the actual checkout and account terms before committing. Marketplaces provide tools and possible discovery; none is assumed to guarantee traffic, approval, sales, or profit.

Modeling assumptions

All prices for Aadil's services, courses, books, memberships, and tutoring are proposed tests. Funnel conversion rates, refund rates, staffing costs, and budgets are illustrative. Two-month cohort arithmetic is a simplification for planning; actual revenue recognition should follow delivery and appropriate accounting advice. Availability, current income, owned audience size, business budget, and a target arrival date have not been confirmed.